

# Minneapolis Police Department

Patrol Division — Traffic Services  
350 S 5th Street, Minneapolis, MN 55415

## OFFICIAL TRAFFIC COLLISION REPORT

(612) 555-0198 | Emergency: 911

|                  |                                                                       |                              |                                                                   |
|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| CASE NUMBER      | MPD-26-01-24-0881                                                     | WEATHER                      | Blizzard (visibility < 150 ft, 8 in snow in 6 hrs, winds 40 mph)  |
| DATE OF INCIDENT | January 24, 2026                                                      | LIGHT CONDITIONS             | Dawn / Whiteout                                                   |
| TIME OF INCIDENT | 07:51 hrs                                                             | ROADWAY SURFACE              | Deep Snow / Drifting / Packed Ice beneath                         |
| LOCATION         | I-94 Westbound, Exit 235 vicinity (Huron Blvd), Minneapolis, MN 55414 | TYPE OF COLLISION / VEHICLES | 6-vehicle chain pileup + bystander pedestrian struck / 6 vehicles |

### SECTION 1 — RESPONDING UNITS

|                       |                                                                      |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Responding Agency     | Minneapolis Police Department                                        |
| Investigating Officer | Officer Angela R. Sorensen, Badge #2219                              |
| Officer Phone         | (612) 555-0198 ext. 712                                              |
| EMS Agency            | HCMC EMS — Medic 1, Medic 7, Medic 12 (transported six persons)      |
| Tow Companies         | Metro Towing Authority (V3, V4, V5, V6); owner (V1, V2)              |
| Additional Units      | Sgt. M. Bjornstad #3341; MnDOT Incident Response; MSP Troop H Unit 9 |

### SECTION 2 — VEHICLES

| #  | Year / Make / Model       | VIN               | Plate            | Damage                                                                                     |
|----|---------------------------|-------------------|------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| V1 | 2021 Toyota RAV4          | 2T3H1RFV1MC081801 | MN-BKP-4418 (MN) | Rear bumper deformed; minor; drivable                                                      |
| V2 | 2019 Honda Pilot          | 5FNYP8H24KB041801 | MN-CRT-8821 (MN) | Front and rear deformed — sandwiched; driver airbag deployed; stuck in snow                |
| V3 | 2022 Chevy Silverado 1500 | 3GCUKREC0NG218801 | MN-DXW-3319 (MN) | Front bumper, hood, grille destroyed; airbag deployed; coolant loss                        |
| V4 | 2020 Ford Fusion          | 3FA6P0HD0LR241801 | MN-ELM-7723 (MN) | Front end destroyed; roof partially deformed from snow accumulation post-crash; total loss |
| V5 | 2018 Subaru Forester      | JF2SJAEC0JH412801 | MN-FTR-441 (MN)  | Front bumper, grille — moderate; airbag deployed; drivable                                 |
| V6 | 2023 Ram 1500             | 1C6SRFLT7PN341801 | MN-GXK-224 (MN)  | Front bumper, hood — moderate; airbag deployed; drivable with caution                      |

**SECTION 3 — DRIVERS / OPERATORS**

| Party     | Name               | DOB        | License      | Citation                                               |
|-----------|--------------------|------------|--------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Driver V1 | Ingrid L. Larson   | 06/12/1983 | MN-L44218301 | None                                                   |
| Driver V2 | David T. Petersen  | 09/28/1978 | MN-P88234107 | MN Stat. §169.14 — Speed Not Reasonable for Conditions |
| Driver V3 | Chidi E. Obi       | 04/07/1991 | MN-O77187213 | MN Stat. §169.14 — Speed Not Reasonable for Conditions |
| Driver V4 | Wei T. Chen        | 11/15/1986 | MN-C44219801 | MN Stat. §169.14 — Speed Not Reasonable for Conditions |
| Driver V5 | Tamara J. Williams | 03/22/1995 | MN-W88219812 | None                                                   |
| Driver V6 | Eric B. Hoffman    | 07/19/1971 | MN-H44187320 | None                                                   |

**SECTION 4 — PASSENGERS**

| Veh   | Name                                       | DOB        | Injury                                                                       | Transported                                                           |
|-------|--------------------------------------------|------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| V2    | Linda E. Petersen                          | 08/30/1980 | Serious: left rib fractures, head contusion, cervical strain                 | Yes — HCMC Medic 1, to Hennepin Healthcare (serious)                  |
| V2    | Owen M. Petersen                           | 05/14/2015 | Moderate: forehead laceration, arm bruise; booster seat intact               | Yes — HCMC Medic 7, to Childrens Minnesota (stable)                   |
| V4    | Amy R. Chen                                | 12/03/1988 | Critical: loss of consciousness, head trauma, airbag and roof contact        | Yes — HCMC Medic 1, to Hennepin Healthcare Trauma (trauma activation) |
| PED-1 | Robert K. Halvorsen (bystander pedestrian) | 03/11/1955 | Serious: struck while assisting at scene — right arm fracture, rib contusion | Yes — HCMC Medic 12, to Hennepin Healthcare (serious)                 |
| V3    | Nneka F. Obi                               | 10/28/1993 | Moderate: whiplash, shoulder contusion                                       | Yes — HCMC Medic 7, to HCMC (stable)                                  |
| V5    | Derek L. Williams                          | 02/17/2020 | Minor: child seat intact; EMS evaluated, no injury apparent                  | No — parents declined, EMS concurred                                  |

**SECTION 5 — WITNESSES**

| #  | Name                                       | Address                                                        | Phone                   | Statement                                                                                                                         |
|----|--------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| W1 | Catherine M. Holst                         | Following motorist, stopped safely on shoulder                 | (612) 555-0341          | Yes — confirmed sequence V1 through V6; written statement                                                                         |
| W2 | James A. Tunney                            | Bystander who called 911 re: pedestrian Halvorsen being struck | (612) 555-0448          | Yes — witnessed Halvorsen exit his vehicle to assist and be struck by a secondary slide of V3 during the chain; written statement |
| W3 | MnDOT Incident Response Supervisor K. Ness | MnDOT District 9 Traffic Management                            | (612) 555-0512          | Yes — confirmed DMS at I-94/I-35W junction was displaying blizzard advisory; provided MnDOT incident log                          |
| W4 | Sgt. M. Bjornstad #3341                    | MPD Patrol, arrived 07:58 hrs                                  | (612) 555-0198 ext. 801 | Yes — co-commanding officer; supplemental narrative attached                                                                      |
| W5 | MSP Trooper P. Halverson #144              | MSP Troop H, arrived 08:06 hrs                                 | MSP Internal            | Yes — MSP SR1003 filed; vehicle measurements and diagram taken                                                                    |

**SECTION 6 — PROPERTY DAMAGE (NON-VEHICLE)**

|  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|--|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  | I-94 WB concrete median barrier at MM 235.1 — V4 contacted barrier; two panels cracked. MnDOT emergency crew dispatched. Pedestrian bystander Halvorsen's parked vehicle (2017 Toyota Camry, MN-HPV-881) — struck by V3 slide; right front corner deformed. |
|--|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

**SECTION 7 — NARRATIVE**

On Saturday January 24, 2026 at approximately 07:51 hrs, this officer, Sgt. Bjornstad, Minnesota State Patrol Trooper Halverson, and MnDOT Incident Response were dispatched to I-94 westbound at the Exit 235 (Huron Blvd) vicinity in Minneapolis on report of a multi-vehicle chain collision with multiple serious injuries and a bystander pedestrian struck. A blizzard was in effect with an official National Weather Service Blizzard Warning active since 22:00 hrs on January 23. At the time of the incident, approximately 8 inches of snow had accumulated over 6 hours. Sustained winds were 40 mph with gusts to 55 mph. Visibility was estimated at under 150 feet. The roadway surface consisted of deep drifted snow over packed ice. V1 (2021 Toyota RAV4, Larson) was traveling westbound at a significantly reduced speed, estimated 25 mph, appropriate for blizzard conditions. V1 slowed further approaching the Huron Blvd exit and came to a controlled near-stop. V2 (2019 Honda Pilot, Petersen) was following V1 and struck V1's rear at an estimated 40 mph despite the blizzard conditions, failing to maintain a safe following distance. V2 came to a hard stop blocking the center lane. V3 (2022 Chevrolet Silverado, Obi) struck the rear of V2 with significant force; V3's momentum and the icy surface caused it to slide forward into V2 and then into the right lane. V4 (2020 Ford Fusion, Chen) struck V3's rear at a speed estimated by witness Holst as considerably higher than appropriate for conditions; V4 slid into the concrete median barrier. V5 (2018 Subaru Forester, Williams) struck V3 at a reduced speed after attempting emergency braking. V6 (2023 Ram 1500, Hoffman) was the final vehicle in the chain, striking V5's rear at low speed. Bystander pedestrian Robert Halvorsen, age 70, had stopped his vehicle (2017 Toyota Camry) approximately 80 yards behind the pileup upon observing the collision. He exited his vehicle to attempt to assist injured occupants. As he approached the scene on foot, V3 experienced a secondary slide event on the icy surface approximately 90 seconds after the initial chain, moving approximately 15 feet rearward. V3's rear contacted Halvorsen, fracturing his right arm and causing rib contusion. Witness James Tunney, who had stopped safely and remained in his vehicle, observed Halvorsen exit his car and witnessed the secondary V3 slide. This officer documented the bystander pedestrian incident as a separate sub-event within this case. MnDOT Incident Response Supervisor Ness confirmed the I-94/I-35W dynamic message sign had been displaying "BLIZZARD — REDUCE SPEED" since 06:12 hrs. V4 passenger Amy Chen was found unresponsive with head trauma and was transported under trauma activation to Hennepin Healthcare. V2 passenger Linda Petersen was transported in serious condition with rib fractures. V2 passenger Owen Petersen, age 10 (booster seat intact), was transported in stable condition to Children's Minnesota. V3 passenger Nneka Obi was transported in stable condition. Bystander Halvorsen was transported in serious condition to Hennepin Healthcare. V5 passenger Derek Williams, age 5 (forward-facing seat intact), was evaluated by EMS with no injury found; parents declined transport and EMS concurred. V1 driver Larson and V5/V6 drivers were uninjured.

## SECTION 9 — SUPPLEMENTAL INVESTIGATION NOTES

SUPPLEMENTAL — BYSTANDER PEDESTRIAN INCIDENT AND SECONDARY SLIDE INVESTIGATION: The striking of bystander Robert Halvorsen by V3 during a secondary slide constitutes a separate vehicular incident within this case. Driver Obi (V3) was outside the vehicle at the time of the secondary slide; no driver input caused the slide. The slope of the roadway at MM 235.1 (grade: -0.9% westbound) combined with packed ice beneath the snow surface allowed V3's 5,800 lb vehicle to slide rearward under gravity. No citation has been issued to Obi related to the pedestrian strike; however, Sgt. Bjornstad has requested legal review from the MPD City Attorney liaison on whether MN Stat. §169.14 applies to the secondary slide event. BLIZZARD DOCUMENTATION: NWS Minneapolis-Twin Cities official Blizzard Warning (NPW-MNZ035-024-2026-0124) was in effect from 22:00 hrs January 23 through 12:00 hrs January 24. NWS confirms 8.2 inches of snowfall at MSP Airport from 00:00–08:00 hrs on January 24. MnDOT District 9 road condition report for I-94 WB at 07:00 hrs shows "snow-covered/icy" with plowing active but unable to keep pace with accumulation rate. CHILD PASSENGERS: Owen Petersen (V2, age 10, booster seat) — seat intact; replacement recommended per NHTSA per-crash protocol. Derek Williams (V5, age 5, forward-facing harness) — seat intact; no visible deformation. Replacement nevertheless recommended given crash severity; parents informed. V4 TOTAL LOSS AND ROOF DEFORMATION NOTE: V4 (Ford Fusion, Chen) sustained post-crash roof deformation from approximately 14 inches of snow accumulation during the extended scene processing time (08:51 hrs to 11:24 hrs closure). This is noted for insurance documentation purposes and does not alter the crash-related damage assessment which was documented photographically at 08:15 hrs. I-94 WB CLOSURE: Full closure at Exit 237 from 08:12 to 12:44 hrs. MnDOT diverted traffic to US-12 (Wayzata Blvd). MnDOT TIM log attached as Exhibit A.

**SECTION 10 — CITATIONS / CHARGES SUMMARY**

| Party                | Statute          | Violation                                      | Fine / Disposition |
|----------------------|------------------|------------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| Driver V2 (Petersen) | MN Stat. §169.14 | Speed Not Reasonable for Conditions — blizzard | Civil Penalty      |
| Driver V3 (Obi)      | MN Stat. §169.14 | Speed Not Reasonable for Conditions — blizzard | Civil Penalty      |
| Driver V4 (Chen)     | MN Stat. §169.14 | Speed Not Reasonable for Conditions — blizzard | Civil Penalty      |

**SECTION 8 — OFFICER SIGN-OFF**

*signed*

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**Officer Angela R. Sorensen, Badge #2219**

Investigating Officer, Minneapolis Police Department Traffic Services

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**January 24, 2026**

Date